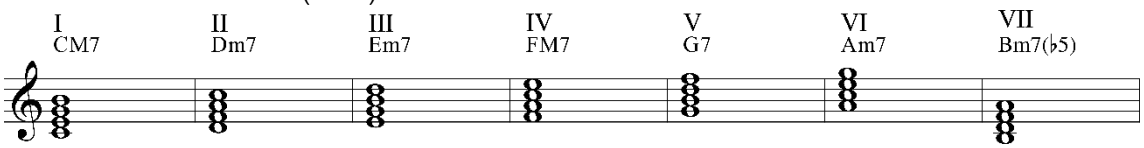
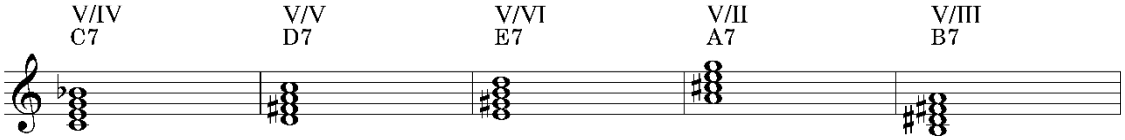
Lexicon of Functional Categories

According to the theoretical model on functionality in extended-harmony popular music proposed by Almada (2025),[1] it is possible to establish a kind of taxonomy of functional categories, organized in classes and subclasses, listed as follows:[2]

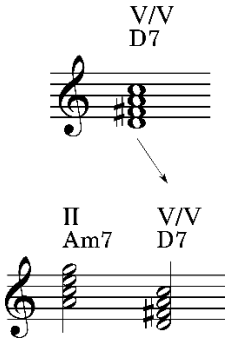
1. **Class Diatonic** (DIA): includes the seven diatonic seventh chords.



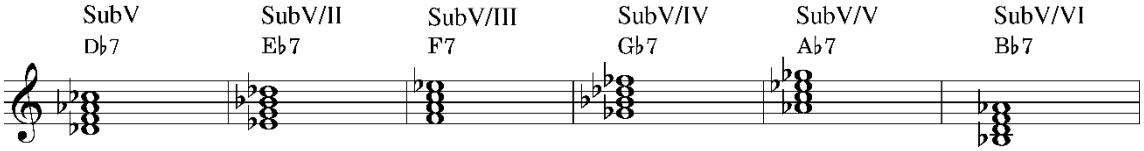
2. **Class Preparers** (PRE): includes chords that prepare DIA members. It has three subclasses:
   a. **Secondary Dominants** (DS): their members model the formula V-I



All DS chords can be decomposed according to the "II-V" formula ("two-five", in popular-musical jargon), creating "secondary twos" as illustrated bellow:[3]



   b. **Tritonic substitutes** (SUB): their members are distanced one tritone apart from their respective DS equivalents (and have the same tritones):[4]



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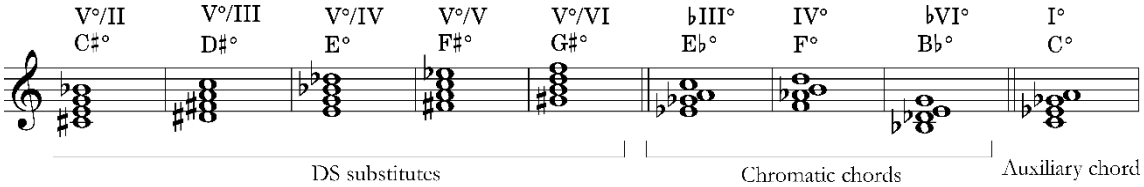
[1] Almada, C. (2025). Funcionalidade Harmônica em Música Popular. Editora da Unicamp, Campinas.

[2] For simplicity, only major-mode categories are considered here. All the examples are referred to the key of C major.

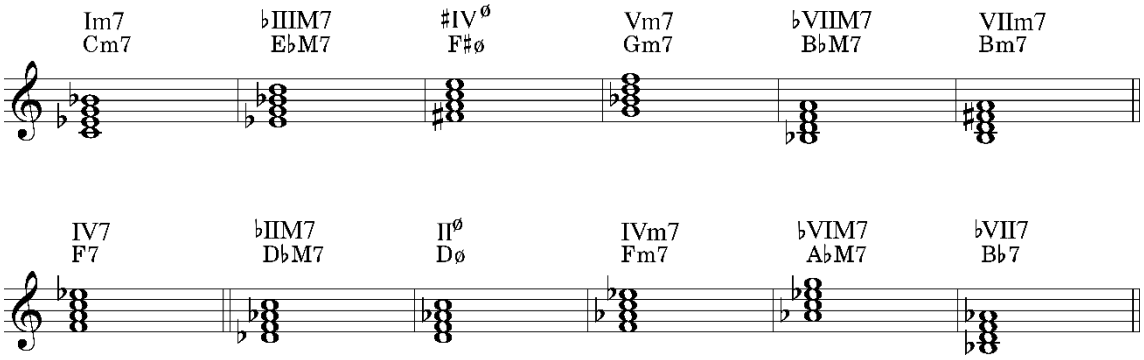
[3] These secondary twos are generically encoded in our Project as II__X.

[4] Including the "primary" SubV that can substitute V.

c. **Diminished-seventh preparers** (DIM)

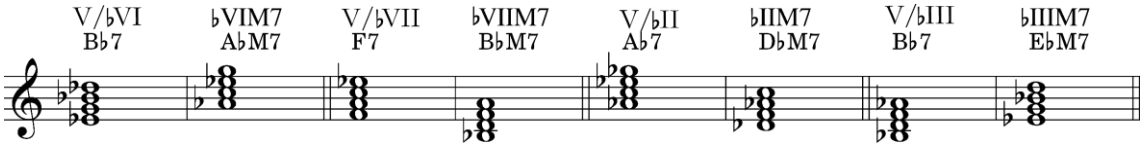


3. **Borrowing chords** (E1): Chromatic categories, borrowed from tonal regions close to the tonic region.

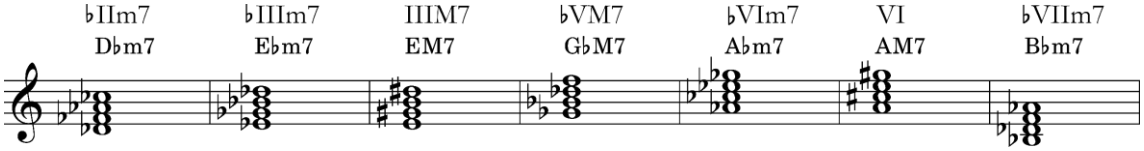


The remaining four functional classes are characteristic in some of the MPB repertoire, although considerable rare if compared to the previous ones.

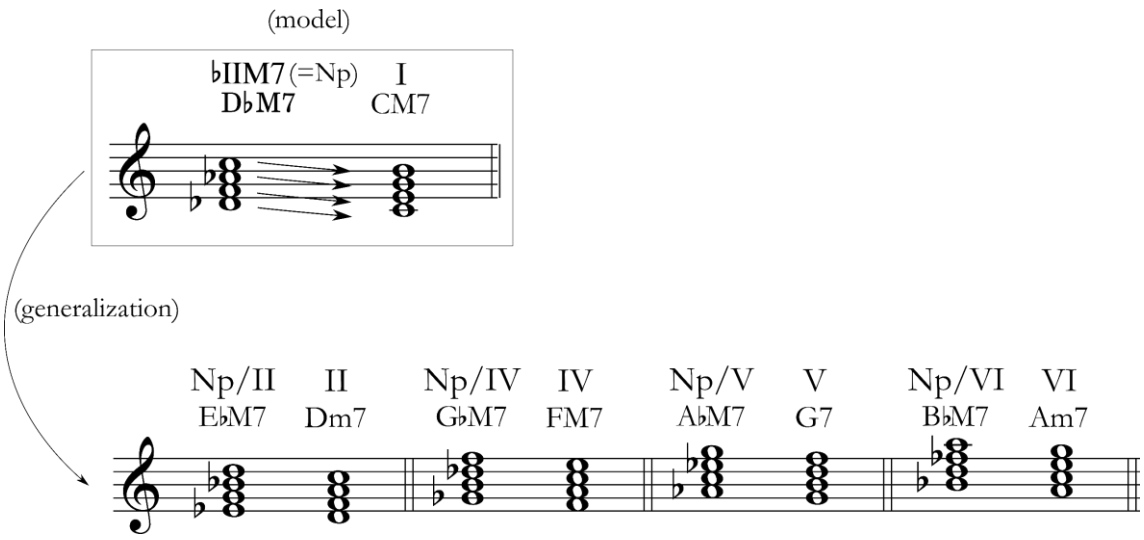
4. **Tertiary Dominants** (DT): The members of this class are dominant preparations for borrowing chords with flattened root.



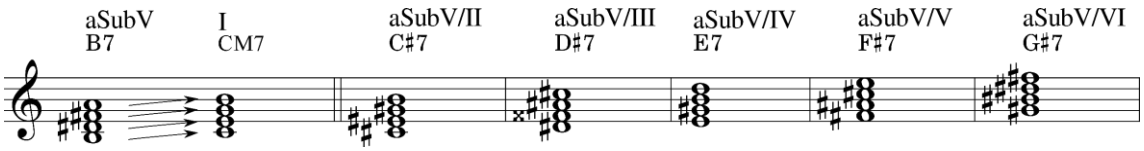
5. **Second-order borrowing chords** (E2): Basically, the members of this class are borrowing chords related to some categories of the E1 class.



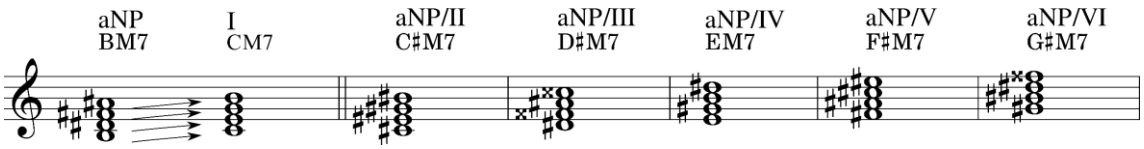
6. **Secondary Neapolitan** (NPs): the functional categories of this class model the formula "bIIM7-I" having as targets other four diatonic chords.



7. **Anti-preparers** (aPRE): the members of this class function as alternative preparers of diatonic chords by semitonal ascending attraction of their respective roots. There are two subclasses:
    a. **Anti-Tritonic Substitutes** (aSUBV): its members behave as inverted versions of subclass SUBV.



    b. **Anti-Neapolitan** (aNP): its members behave as inverted versions of class NPS.



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Note: Besides all these functional symbols the interrogation mark (?) represents chords whose function could not be unambiguously interpreted in the harmonic analysis. Mostly, a chord assigned to "?" is only a chromatic passing chord bridging two other ones.